

## Global semiconductor revenue to grow by 20 per cent

Worldwide semiconductor revenue will total \$411.1 billion in 2017, an increase of 19.7 per cent from 2016—according to Gartner, Inc.

“Memory continues to lead the semiconductor market higher and is expected to increase 57 per cent in 2017 as supply and demand dynamics increase prices. A shortage of memory, and in particular DRAM, is driving semiconductor revenue higher,” said Jon Erensen, research director at Gartner. “Strength is spreading

to other semiconductor categories as well with non-optical sensors, analogue, discretes and image sensors all forecast to grow over 10 per cent in 2017.”

“Higher memory costs and component shortages are cause for concern as we enter the fourth quarter,” said Erensen. “Memory is driving the bill-of-materials cost higher across electronic equipment categories and we are starting to see increased costs get passed on by OEMs through higher pricing.”

## Device sales to increase 2 per cent in 2018

Worldwide sales of PCs, tablets and smartphones are predicted to exceed 2.35 billion units in 2018, an increase of 2 per cent from 2017, according to Gartner, Inc. This would be the highest year-over-year growth since 2015.

The misconception persists that the world has gone mobile and relies solely on smartphones. “However, our latest online end-user survey shows that users depend just as much on PCs or tablets as

they do on smartphones,” said Ranjit Atwal, research director at Gartner.

“Forty per cent of respondents said that they use mostly a PC/tablet for certain daily experiences, such as reading and writing detailed emails or watching videos, while 34 per cent mostly use a smartphone for its convenience while on the move.”

Traditional PC shipments are forecast to decline 4.4 per cent in 2018, while mobile phone shipments are expected to increase 2.4 per cent.

## AR headsets to gain momentum by 2020

The combined augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR) headset market will reach 13.7 million units in 2017, and grow annually at 56 per cent to reach 81.2

million units by 2021, according to IDC. VR headsets will account for more than 90 per cent of the market until 2019, while AR will account for the rest. In the final two years

## On The Move

### Former Intel CEO Paul Otellini passed away

The semiconductor industry mourns the loss of former Intel CEO, Paul Otellini, who passed away recently at the age of 66. Otellini was a self-proclaimed Intel ‘lifer,’ dedicating four decades to the organisation. His dedication, leadership and vision helped make Intel what it is today—the world’s largest chipmaker and the foundation for affordable wireless communication and smart devices that comprise today’s Internet of Things.

### Immelt exits GE ahead of plan

General Electric (GE)’s Jeffrey Immelt has retired as chairman and left the board months ahead of schedule. He was expected to step down as chairman of Boston-based GE at the end of the year. John Flannery, who took over as chief executive officer from Immelt in August, was elected chairman. GE said Immelt had determined the CEO transition was proceeding smoothly and that Flannery was ready to take over as chairman.

### ELCINA elects office bearers for 2017-18

Pankaj Gulati, chief operating officer of Continental Device India Limited (CDIL) has been elected as the new president of Electronic Industries Association of India (ELCINA) for the year 2017-18. The other ELCINA office bearers elected include Amrit Manwani of Sahasra Electronics as the senior vice president, Pareswari Vasani of Circuit Systems as vice president and Vijay Gujrathi of EOS Power as honorary secretary.

### AKAI appoints Sethi as director of sales and operations

AKAI India has appointed Neeraj Sethi as the director of India sales and operations. Before joining AKAI India, Sethi worked with a number of consumer durables giants including Philips Electrolux Electronics (PE Electronics), Eureka Forbes, Videocon, LG and Samsung.